Close eye on safety

As a demonstrator at the IWG Seminar, we had an initial meeting where all the relevant safety protocols were listed. It outlined what we could and could not do as demonstrators and covered fire escapes, first aid, rotation times, food and drink breaks and so on. This year, there was a new Health & Safety initiative in the shape of a taped orange line across all the demonstration room floors. It was positioned about two metres in front of the lathes and woe betide any attendees who dared to cross it. This simple device kept everyone clear of potential trips, AV equipment and, of course, sharp tools.

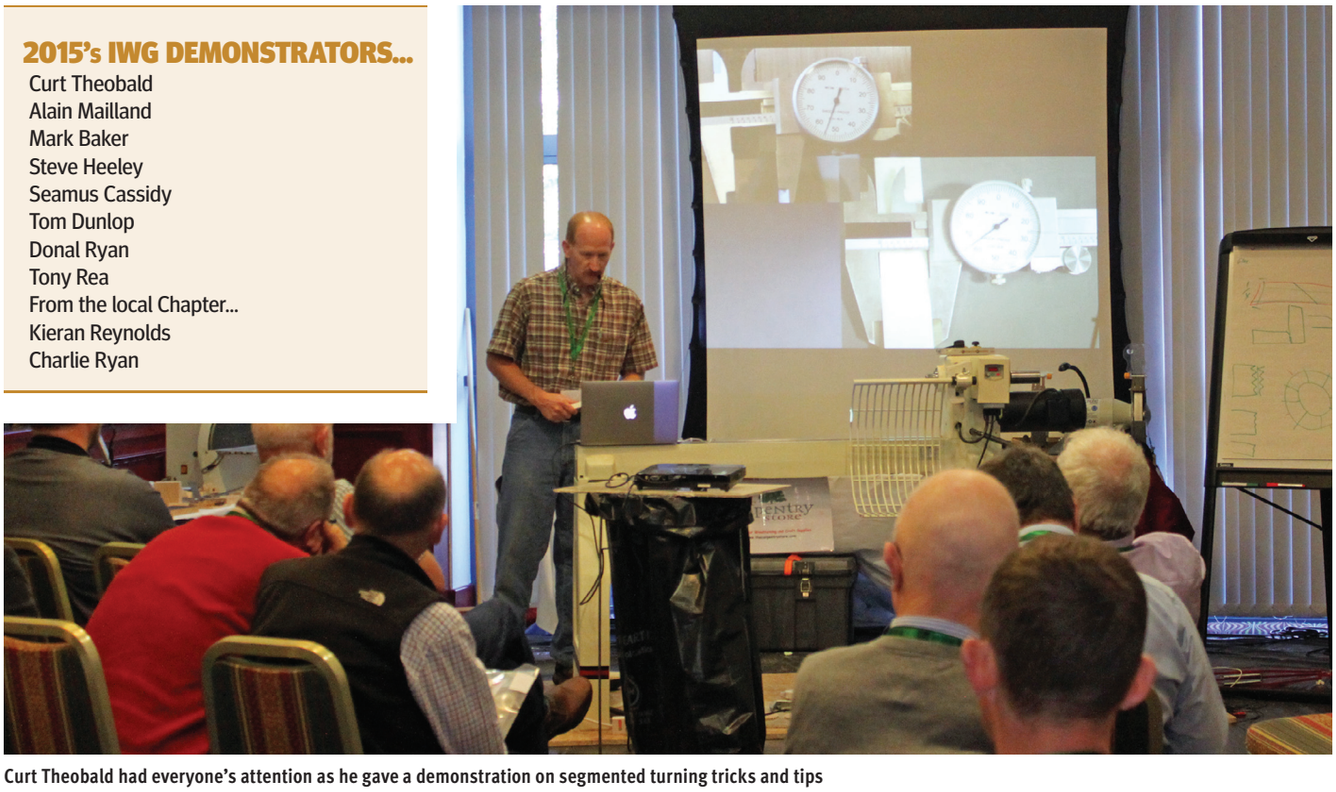
The lathes had full protective screens in front of them, too, and demonstrators had to use protective eyewear or full face shields. Any demonstrator found not to be using the minimum of protective eyewear was likely to lose his or her demo fee. A nice idea, I thought. Keeping on the safety theme, some seminars now state that it is obligatory to use a face shield for lathe-based demonstrations. Again something for organisers to think about, but it is a good suggestion.

The rotations represented a wide range of turning options so there was plenty of choice for people. This is vital for a good seminar. Diversity is a must. More and more people are tackling, or at least want to attempt, a wider variety of projects and enhancement techniques and it is important that seminars reflect this trend. Some of the attendees I spoke to during and after the event said that while it was fun to catch up with friends, it was also important to have the chance to meet new people and see fresh ways of working. Two people told me it had been worth attending the seminar just to see one particular demonstration as it had solved some problem areas for them. The instant gallery and display were a delight. While there were perhaps fewer items than in previous years, it was still a pleasure to see the diversity on display. Various demonstrators were asked to pair up to judge certain categories. This is always a hard job, but it's also fun as the judges can get up close to work to see how things were done. It also gives a real insight into what the makers are doing and what they have created.

Demonstrators, including Kieran Reynolds, were obliged to use protective eyewear or full face shields

2015's IWG DEMONSTRATORS...

Curt Theobald
Alain Mailland
Mark Baker
Steve Heeley
Seamus Cassidy
Tom Dunlop
Donal Ryan
Tony Rea
From the local Chapter...
Kieran Reynolds
Charlie Ryan



Curt Theobald had everyone's attention as he gave a demonstration on segmented turning tricks and tips

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